

Reversible or Not?

One question that tells you when to move fast, and when to slow down.

BEFORE YOU PLAN, TIDY, OR BUILD ANYTHING, ASK:

How expensive is this to reverse?



TWO-WAY DOOR

Cheap to reverse. Undo it in seconds and lose almost nothing.

Stop planning. Just try it.

Make the rough version. See if it works.
Pivot if it doesn't. Sloppy and fast beats careful and slow.

Usually: a draft, a layout, a title, a workflow tweak, most content. Almost everything.



ONE-WAY DOOR

Expensive to reverse. You're stuck with it, or it costs real time and trust to unpick.

Slow down. Bring the rigor.

Bring the checklist. Take the extra pass.
Move in the smallest safe step you can.

Usually: money you don't get back, a public promise, data you can't un-migrate, a subscriber's trust. Rare.

Most of your work is a **two-way door**. That's why moving fast is usually right. Save your care for the few doors you can't walk back.

The Lean Sensei prompt

Paste this into any chatbot with your plan, and it runs the whole audit: what to just try, what to slow down on, and what to stop making. Prefer one click? Install the [Claude skill](#).

FILL IN YOUR PLAN, THEN PASTE

I am about to build or organise [the plan, workflow, or task]. What "done" looks like for me is [the outcome I want].

You are the Lean Sensei. Tell me how much rigor this actually needs before I sink effort in. Audit it in this order:

1. Spot the waste. List everything this will produce that I then have to review, check, choose between, or maintain.
2. Triage each part. Two-way door (cheap to reverse) or one-way door (expensive or impossible to undo)?
3. Route it. For two-way doors, tell me to stop planning and just try, and name the fastest rough test plus the signal that means "back out." For any one-way door, and only there, bring the rigor.
4. Protect my attention. Flag anything I'm making only because making is cheap, that I then have to sit and review. Tell me what to make less of.

End with one clear next action, not a menu.

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From the post: "I Reviewed My Substack Workflow. Most of It Didn't Need Fixing."

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